

Up Top Search: systems that helped them scale to over \$3M in revenue and 400+ clients

About Up Top Search

Up Top Search, founded in 2021, is a talent agency specializing in the blockchain and digital asset sectors, including algorithmic trading and blockchain engineering. They work with over 100 clients across various domains such as infrastructure, gaming, DeFi, Layer 1s, consumer services, and exchanges. The agency excels in connecting talented individuals with appropriate opportunities, averaging about 4 hires per month last year. Their focus is on building a skilled workforce at the forefront of web3 and digital assets, offering a comprehensive network for career development in the crypto industry.

Clients We're Building With



Previous workflow cycle: Challenges

Up Top Search faced significant challenges stemming from their expensive, feature-rich, yet rigid systems, particularly in candidate and client management.

Marcus from Up Top highlighted these inefficiencies, noting a clear misalignment between the available system features and their specific operational needs.

The Client Management System (CMS) posed notable issues with inefficient role selection processes and communication hurdles, hindering the effectiveness of client interactions. Concurrently, the Talent Management System (TMS) was inadequate, lacking sophisticated candidate filtering and management capabilities. The team urgently required advanced tools for detailed tracking of candidates throughout the hiring lifecycle, including the ability to compile and present both individual and aggregated feedback clearly on client-facing pages. Additionally, there was a pressing need for more personalized and intuitive approaches to managing referrals and back-channel communications.

Furthermore, the existing system complicated the effective management of collaborative documents, vital resource links, and seamless integration of social media and content strategies. Consequently, the team found themselves dedicating excessive amounts of time to manual administrative tasks and CRM management. This significant diversion from their core competencies—supporting talent and providing exceptional client service—highlighted the necessity for a more tailored, flexible, and efficient operational solution, particularly suited to the rapidly evolving dynamics of the crypto industry.

Our Approach

Diagnosis

Initially, we conducted a comprehensive review of Up Top's former workspace and their operational systems.

This initial phase involved an examination of their use of Notion and other tools. We asked for clarifications and the reasons behind certain areas where team members identified productivity challenges, as well as their workspace necessities and preferences.

In the spirit of Design Thinking, we gathered all pertinent information directly from the Talent Partners at Up Top. We utilized this insight to devise and execute a

strategy that emphasizes a Systems Thinking approach, benefiting both the organization and its employees.

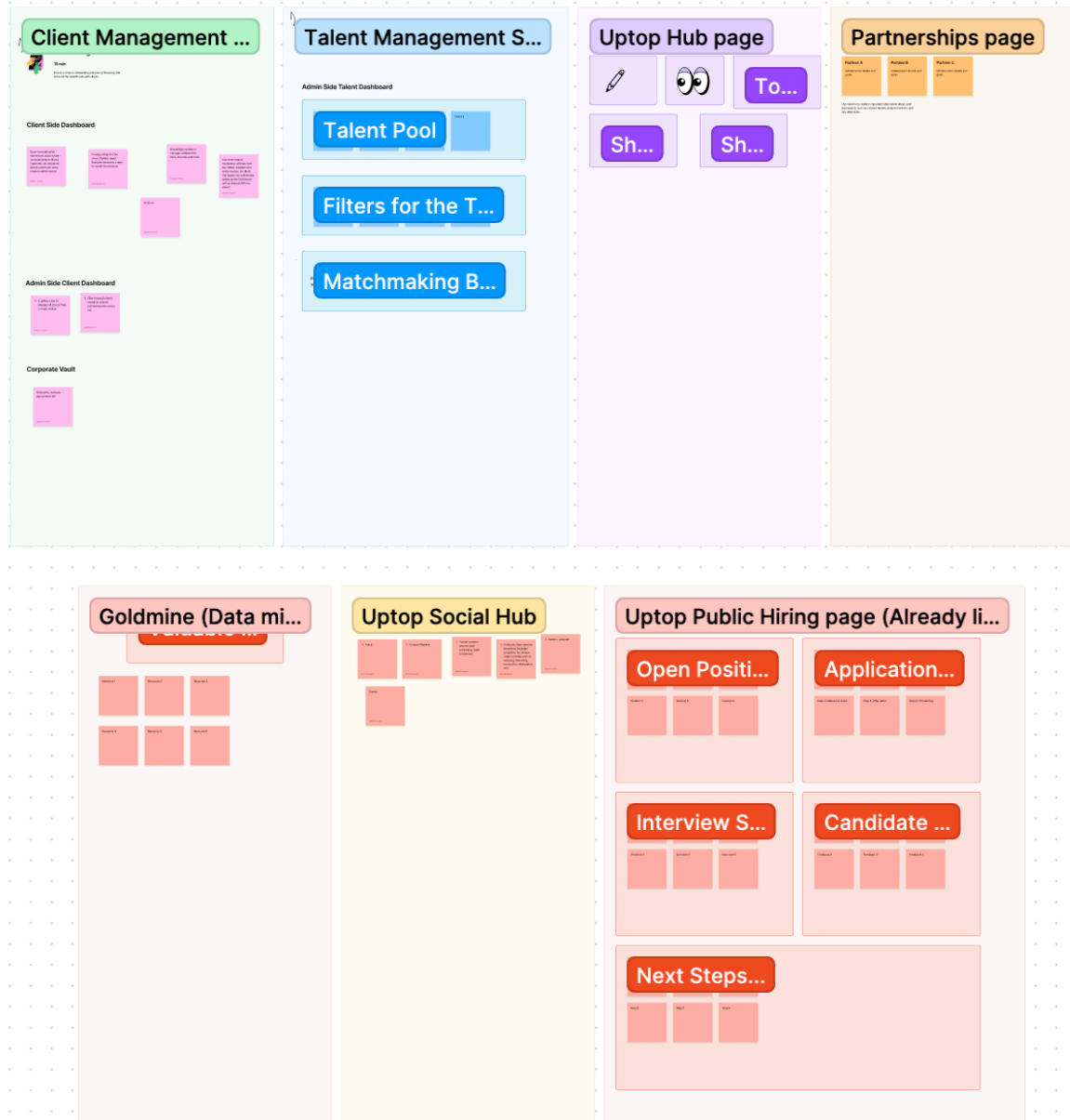
StoryMap

The objective was to thoroughly explore and document individual feature requests.

Phase 1: Using Notion to maintain their behavioural patterns

Up Top Search's envisioned Notion workspace is a comprehensive ecosystem, seamlessly integrating a Client Management System for efficient role selection and communication, a Talent Management System with robust candidate filtering and tracking, along with collaborative knowledge systems and social media dashboards. This dream setup, complete with admin and client dashboards, invoicing, and a data mine page, aims to streamline operations and foster better engagement between Up Top and their clients, enabling a smooth and scalable operational flow.

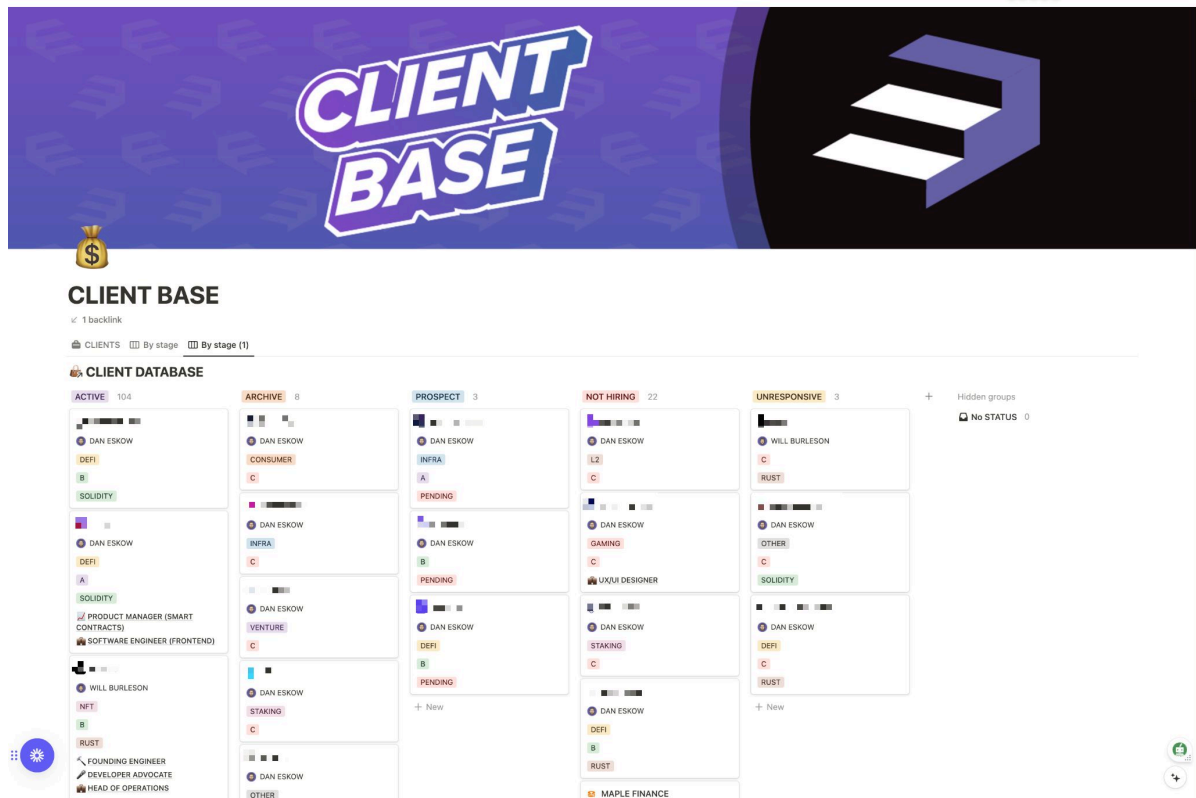
UP TOP NOTION OUTLINE



Development

To reorganize Up Top Search's Notion workspace for enhanced visibility and scalability, a multi-faceted approach was necessary:

- **Client Management System (CMS):** A centralized hub for managing client interactions, with streamlined processes for open roles selection and efficient client communications. A gallery view for revisiting previous hires and a comprehensive dashboard for ongoing client engagements would enhance operational efficiency.



- **Talent Management System (TMS):** This system would include a refined talent pool, categorized by various parameters for efficient candidate management and matchmaking.



TALENT BASE

1 backlink

CANDIDATE ONBOARDING

ALL APPLIED DAN MARTY BD MARKETING DEVS MARCUS JOE WILL CHRIS TRADING COMMUNITY MIKE 7 more...

CANDIDATE DATABASE

NAME	LOCATION	UP TOP POC	SKU	STATUS	EXPERTISE	RECENT EMPLOYER	RESUME	SKILLS
	United Kingdom	DAN ESKOW	B	ACTIVE	OPERATIONS			BIZ DEV
	San Francisco	DAN ESKOW	A	PASSIVE SEARCH	MARKETING			MARKETING
	Vietnam	MARTY AUSTRIA	A	ACTIVE	ENGINEERING			DEVOPS
	London (UK)	JOE ZAMM	B	ACTIVE	ENGINEERING			SOLIDITY SMART CONTRACTS
		JOE ZAMM	C	PASSIVE SEARCH				
	France	MARCUS DORSEN	C	ACTIVE	PRODUCT			
	New Jersey	DAN ESKOW	A	ACTIVE	OPERATIONS			TRADING OPERATIONS
	Lisbon	DAN ESKOW	B	ACTIVE	ENGINEERING			MACHINE LEARNING PYTHON DATA SCIENCE
	London	JOE ZAMM	B	ACTIVE	ENGINEERING			RUST SOLIDITY
	Dubai London (UK)	JOE ZAMM	A	ACTIVE	MARKETING			MARKETING BIZ DEV
	Berlin	JOE ZAMM	A	ACTIVE	ENGINEERING			SMART CONTRACTS TYPESCRIPT
	Portugal	JOE ZAMM	A	ACTIVE	PRODUCT			PRODUCT
	Los Angeles	WILL BURLESON	C	ACTIVE	OPERATIONS			OPERATIONS
	New York	MARTY AUSTRIA	A	ACTIVE	BIZ DEV			BIZ DEV
	Salt Lake City UT	WILL BURLESON	A	PASSIVE SEARCH	ENGINEERING			LEADERSHIP FULL STACK FRONT END REACT
	London (UK)	WILL BURLESON	B	PASSIVE SEARCH	COMMUNITY			COMMUNITY CONTENT SOCIAL MEDIA
	Berlin	WILL BURLESON	A	PASSIVE SEARCH	PRODUCT			DESIGN

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UP TOP CRM / ACTIVITY BASE Edited 4h ago Share ☆ ...

STEP YOUR GAME UP

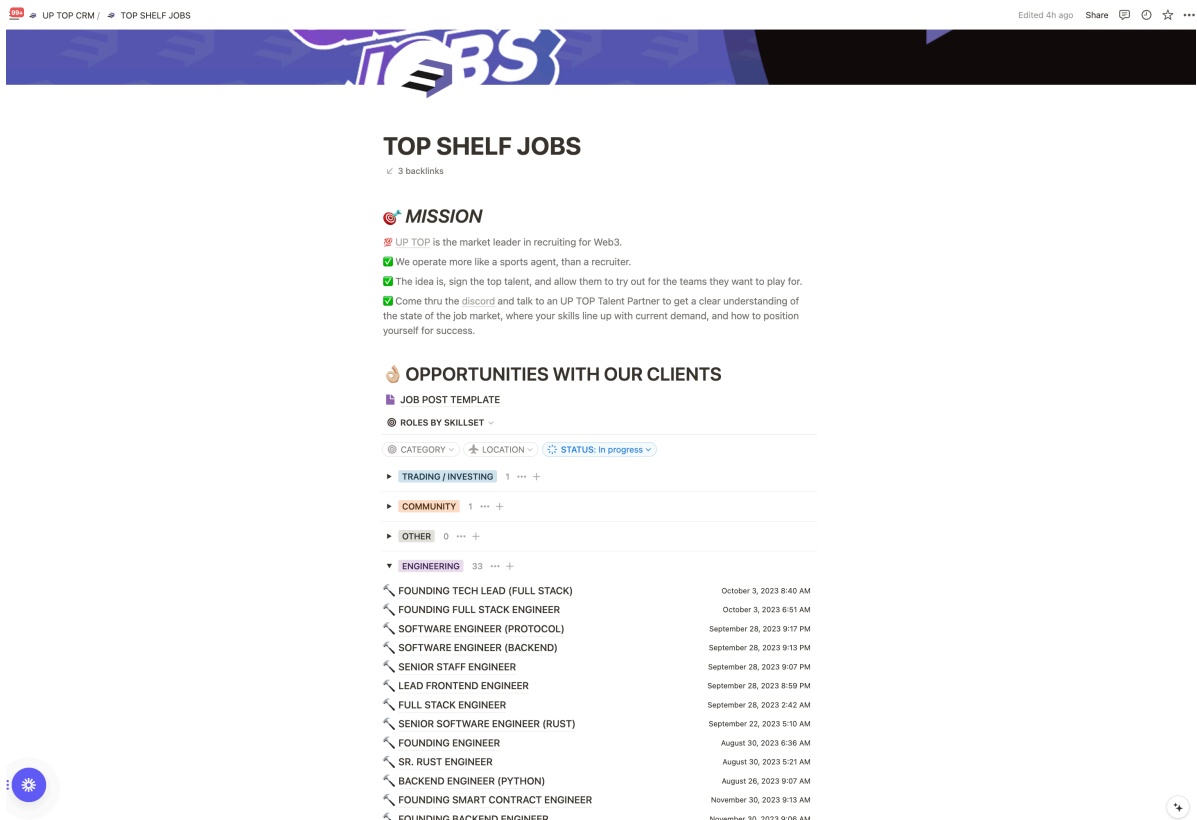
ACTIVITY BASE

ALL PENDING PLACED DAN MARTY JOE WILL MARCUS CHRIS GRAVEYARD MY CLIENTS ALL TEST + Filter Sort 🔍 New

CANDIDATE	CLIENT	ROLE	SALES	RECRUITER	STATUS	NOTE
		BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT LEAD	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT LEAD	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT ASSOCIATE	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		MARKETING	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		OPERATIONS	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		HEAD OF COMMUNITY COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		HEAD OF COMMUNITY COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		HEAD OF COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		DEVOPS ENGINEER	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		OPERATIONS LEAD	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		OPERATIONS LEAD	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		HEAD OF COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		PRODUCT MANAGER (SMART CONTRACTS)	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		PRODUCT MANAGER (SMART CONTRACTS)	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		DEFI ACCOUNT EXECUTIVE	DAN ESKOW	MARCUS DORSEN	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		PRODUCT MANAGER (SMART CONTRACTS)	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		HEAD OF COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	JOE ZAMM	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	WILL BURLESON	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY
		COMMUNITY	DAN ESKOW	WILL BURLESON	SUBMITTED INTERNALLY	ACTIVITY

Calculate COUNT 22

- **Uptop Hub and Partnerships Page:** A repository for crucial documents, links, and templates for partnerships, ensuring easy access and organization.
- **Goldmine and Social Hub:** These sections would serve as dynamic platforms for aggregating valuable information and managing social media content, complete with automated processes for resource-saving and content scheduling.
- **Public Hiring Page:** Integration of this page with other sections for streamlined operations, eliminating manual upload hassles.



Each component is designed to work cohesively, ensuring Up Top Search can effortlessly scale and adapt in the fast-paced crypto industry.

Supercharging the Workspace with Agents and rule-based Automation flows

In our overhaul of Up Top Search's workspace, we didn't just stop at structural improvements; we revolutionized it with a host of automation solutions.

- Automated client invoicing through QuickBooks.
- Automated Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) signing and automatic CRM updates during new client onboarding.
- Automated email updates notifying candidates about their progress throughout the hiring process.
- Automated client data collection and maintenance within the CRM.

- AI-powered agents actively monitoring client websites for new job listings, promptly notifying the relevant parties of newly opened roles.
- Agents enriching the client CRM database with current, accurate information from Crunchbase.
- Custom meeting note summarization with automatic integration into candidate profiles within the CRM.
- Integration with Telegram for real-time notifications regarding new payments and reminders for commission payouts.
- Automated generation of comprehensive monthly reports.
- Automated client banner generation for consistent branding and engagement.

These tailored solutions significantly reduced manual overhead, allowing Up Top Search to refocus on their primary strengths—effectively supporting talent and enhancing client experiences. These were just one part of a broader automation strategy that encompassed several other key areas, streamlining processes and enhancing efficiency across the board. Similar to how we integrated a client submission form with a database in another project, we ensured that every automated solution we implemented for Up Top was tailored to meet their specific operational needs.

Documentation and Training

As part of our services, we consistently interacted with and trained team leaders to support them on various fronts as they scaled.

We also offered them advice and Documentation for the effective upkeep of their Notion workspace, as well as training for all the team leads. This allowed the team leads to easily adapt to their new environment without significant bottlenecks, thereby avoiding a steep learning curve.

The Result: Ready to Scale

The success of this workspace overhaul hinged on improving visibility and organization.

We introduced new multifunctional databases, workflows, and training programs, creating a Notion workspace that's primed for growth. This optimized workspace is designed to bolster both their team's productivity and the company's expansion, both on a national and international scale.

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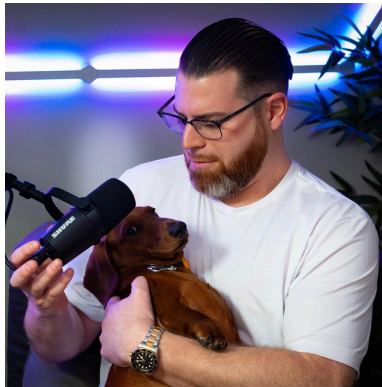


Of all the wins we've had at Up Top in the past year, none have been more impactful than building out this CRM with Harshil and the Crypto Coach team. It's turned me from an unhinged sales guy who hates process, to an operator running a clean business. At this point, I can't imagine my company functioning without it.

Harshil was extremely helpful in walking me through the discovery process, suggesting new features, and delivering on solutions to exactly what I needed to maximize efficiency and organization.

On top of that, the team is always an absolute pleasure to work with. You will never leave a meeting without a laugh or a smile.

Thanks Coach!



~ Dan Eskow (Founder, Up Top Search)